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# G19 — I wish / If only / It's (high) time / Would rather

Les structures de souhait, regret et préférence

|                                                                                         |                                                                                      |                                                                                                                  |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|  17 S4 |  B2 |  marc.vasseur@polytech-lille.fr |
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🔴 Ces structures expriment des souhaits, des regrets ou des préférences que la réalité soit différente. Elles utilisent des temps décalés par rapport à la réalité.

## 1. I wish / If only

| SENS                       | STRUCTURE                         | EXEMPLE                                                 |
|----------------------------|-----------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------|
| Souhait présent irréel     | wish / if only + Past Simple      | I wish I knew the answer. (mais je ne sais pas)         |
| Regret passé               | wish / if only + Past Perfect     | I wish I had studied harder. (mais je ne l'ai pas fait) |
| Irritation / souhait futur | wish / if only + would + V        | I wish you would listen! (tu n'écoutes pas)             |
| Wish + were (formel)       | wish + were (jamais 'was' formel) | I wish I were taller. (+ soutenu que 'was')             |

⚠ On peut utiliser 'was' informellement mais 'were' est correct dans tous les contextes.

## 2. It's (high) time

| Structure                       | Anglais                                                   | Note                                    |
|---------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------|
| It's time + to + V              | It's time to leave. (neutre — on doit partir)             |                                         |
| It's time + sujet + Past Simple | It's time we left. (léger reproche)                       | Même si futur → on utilise le prétérit! |
| It's high time + Past Simple    | It's high time you improved your English! (fort reproche) | High time = grand temps — ton critique  |

## 3. Would rather / Would sooner

| Structure              | Anglais                                  | Note                             |
|------------------------|------------------------------------------|----------------------------------|
| Préférence personnelle | I would rather stay home.                | I'd rather + V base (sans to)    |
| Préférence pour autrui | I'd rather you stayed at home.           | I'd rather + sujet + Past Simple |
| Comparaison            | I'd rather work here than travel abroad. | I'd rather + V + than + V        |

 **wish + passé = irréel présent / wish + Past Perfect = regret passé / It's time + prétérit = urgence maintenant.**



## EXERCICES GUIDÉS

Complète avec la bonne forme.

### Série guidée A — I wish / If only

 souhait présent → prétérit / regret passé → Past Perfect / irritation → would

1. I wish I \_\_\_\_\_ (know) the answer right now.  
→ souhait présent irréel → Past Simple  
→ \_\_\_\_\_
2. She wishes she \_\_\_\_\_ (study) harder before the exam.  
→ regret passé → Past Perfect  
→ \_\_\_\_\_
3. If only it \_\_\_\_\_ (not / rain) every single day!  
→ souhait irréel présent → Past Simple  
→ \_\_\_\_\_
4. I wish you \_\_\_\_\_ (stop) making so much noise.  
→ irritation → would + V base  
→ \_\_\_\_\_
5. He wishes he \_\_\_\_\_ (be) more confident in presentations.  
→ irréel présent → were  
→ \_\_\_\_\_
6. If only they \_\_\_\_\_ (inform) us earlier about the change.  
→ regret passé → Past Perfect  
→ \_\_\_\_\_
7. She wishes she \_\_\_\_\_ (have) more time to dedicate to research.  
→ souhait présent → Past Simple  
→ \_\_\_\_\_
8. I wish the director \_\_\_\_\_ (be) more open to innovative ideas.  
→ irritation → would + V  
→ \_\_\_\_\_
9. If only I \_\_\_\_\_ (choose) a different career path.  
→ regret passé → Past Perfect  
→ \_\_\_\_\_
10. He wishes he \_\_\_\_\_ (speak) better English at the conference.  
→ souhait présent → Past Simple  
→ \_\_\_\_\_

### Série guidée B — It's time / Would rather

 it's time + prétérit (même pour le futur!) / would rather + V base

11. It's time we \_\_\_\_\_ (leave) — the meeting starts in ten minutes.  
→ it's time + prétérit → left  
→ \_\_\_\_\_
12. It's high time he \_\_\_\_\_ (stop) procrastinating and start acting.  
→ high time + prétérit = fort reproche  
→ \_\_\_\_\_

→ \_\_\_\_\_

**13.** I'd rather \_\_\_\_\_ (work) independently on this particular task.

→ would rather + V base

→ \_\_\_\_\_

**14.** I'd rather you \_\_\_\_\_ (not / mention) this to anyone else.

→ would rather + sujet + prétérit

→ \_\_\_\_\_

**15.** It's time \_\_\_\_\_ (start) taking the language requirement seriously.

→ it's time + to + V (infinitif)

→ \_\_\_\_\_

**16.** She would rather \_\_\_\_\_ (stay) in France than \_\_\_\_\_ (move) abroad.

→ would rather + V + than + V

→ \_\_\_\_\_

**17.** It's high time the company \_\_\_\_\_ (invest) in modern equipment.

→ high time + prétérit

→ \_\_\_\_\_

**18.** I'd rather he \_\_\_\_\_ (present) the data himself at the board meeting.

→ would rather + sujet + prétérit

→ \_\_\_\_\_

**19.** It is about time we \_\_\_\_\_ (address) this recurring problem.

→ about time + prétérit

→ \_\_\_\_\_

**20.** She would sooner \_\_\_\_\_ (resign) than compromise her professional ethics.

→ would sooner + V base (= would rather)

→ \_\_\_\_\_



## EXERCICES — NIVEAUX A → B2+

Complète les phrases avec la bonne structure.

### Niveau A — I wish / If only (B1+)

1. I wish I \_\_\_\_\_ (be) better at mathematical modelling.  
→ \_\_\_\_\_
2. She wishes she \_\_\_\_\_ (not / miss) the key conference.  
→ \_\_\_\_\_
3. If only he \_\_\_\_\_ (arrive) on time for once!  
→ \_\_\_\_\_
4. I wish the weather \_\_\_\_\_ (change) — this rain is affecting productivity.  
→ \_\_\_\_\_
5. She wishes she \_\_\_\_\_ (have) more relevant professional experience.  
→ \_\_\_\_\_

### Niveau B — It's time / Would rather (B2)

6. It's time we \_\_\_\_\_ (address) this problem seriously.  
→ \_\_\_\_\_
7. He wishes his team \_\_\_\_\_ (be) more self-motivated.  
→ \_\_\_\_\_
8. I'd rather \_\_\_\_\_ (not / work) overtime this particular week.  
→ \_\_\_\_\_
9. It's high time they \_\_\_\_\_ (update) the outdated software.  
→ \_\_\_\_\_
10. If only I \_\_\_\_\_ (know) about this issue earlier!  
→ \_\_\_\_\_
11. I wish he \_\_\_\_\_ (listen) when I give professional advice.  
→ \_\_\_\_\_
12. She wishes she \_\_\_\_\_ (choose) a different research specialisation.  
→ \_\_\_\_\_
13. It's time you \_\_\_\_\_ (take) full responsibility for your actions.  
→ \_\_\_\_\_
14. I'd rather he \_\_\_\_\_ (present) the results himself at the conference.  
→ \_\_\_\_\_
15. If only we \_\_\_\_\_ (have) more time to prepare thoroughly.  
→ \_\_\_\_\_

### Niveau C — Erreurs et traduction (B2)

→ Corrige les erreurs.

16. I wish I know the answer. → \_\_\_\_\_  
→ \_\_\_\_\_
17. If only she would have told me earlier! → \_\_\_\_\_  
→ \_\_\_\_\_
18. It's time we leave — the taxi is waiting. → \_\_\_\_\_  
→ \_\_\_\_\_
19. I'd rather to work alone on this task. → \_\_\_\_\_  
→ \_\_\_\_\_

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→ \_\_\_\_\_

**20.** She wishes she didn't accepted that position. → \_\_\_\_\_

→ \_\_\_\_\_

→ Traduis en anglais.

**21.** Je regrette de ne pas avoir appris le japonais quand j'en avais l'occasion.

→ \_\_\_\_\_

**22.** Il serait grand temps qu'ils investissent dans de nouveaux équipements.

→ \_\_\_\_\_

**23.** Elle préférerait travailler à Lyon plutôt que de déménager à Paris.

→ \_\_\_\_\_

**24.** Si seulement il avait vérifié ses calculs avant de soumettre le rapport !

→ \_\_\_\_\_

**25.** Il est temps de reconsidérer sérieusement notre approche.

→ \_\_\_\_\_

**Score : \_\_\_\_\_ / 25 points**

### ★ ★ Bonus — Nuances entre wish et hope

Complète avec wish ou hope + la bonne forme.

→ I \_\_\_\_\_ the results will be positive. (expectation realistic)

Réponse : \_\_\_\_\_

→ I \_\_\_\_\_ the results were different. (irréel présent)

Réponse : \_\_\_\_\_

→ She \_\_\_\_\_ she could attend. (souhait irréel — elle ne peut pas)

Réponse : \_\_\_\_\_

→ She \_\_\_\_\_ she can attend. (possibilité réelle future)

Réponse : \_\_\_\_\_

→ We \_\_\_\_\_ the project succeeds — we've worked so hard.

Réponse : \_\_\_\_\_

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## DEVOIR MAISON

Nom & Prénom : \_\_\_\_\_

Groupe : \_\_\_\_\_

Date rendu : \_\_\_\_\_



Complète avec la bonne structure.



Correction envoyée via WhatsApp la semaine prochaine.

1. I wish I \_\_\_\_\_ (speak) perfect English — it would open so many doors.

→ \_\_\_\_\_

2. She wishes she \_\_\_\_\_ (not / accept) that position — it was a mistake.

→ \_\_\_\_\_

3. If only he \_\_\_\_\_ (call) me before making that decision!

→ \_\_\_\_\_

4. It's high time you \_\_\_\_\_ (improve) your academic writing skills.

→ \_\_\_\_\_

5. I'd rather \_\_\_\_\_ (stay) here than travel to the conference tomorrow.

→ \_\_\_\_\_

6. I wish the director \_\_\_\_\_ (be) more open-minded about new proposals.

→ \_\_\_\_\_

7. It's time we \_\_\_\_\_ (have) a serious conversation about the project timeline.

→ \_\_\_\_\_

8. She wishes she \_\_\_\_\_ (study) abroad when she had the opportunity.

→ \_\_\_\_\_

9. I'd rather he \_\_\_\_\_ (not / share) confidential data with external partners.

→ \_\_\_\_\_

10. If only I \_\_\_\_\_ (know) about this technical problem earlier!

→ \_\_\_\_\_

11. It's high time the team \_\_\_\_\_ (adopt) more efficient working practices.

→ \_\_\_\_\_

12. She would sooner \_\_\_\_\_ (resign) than be asked to falsify data.

→ \_\_\_\_\_

13. I wish you \_\_\_\_\_ (stop) interrupting me during presentations.

→ \_\_\_\_\_

14. If only we \_\_\_\_\_ (prepare) more thoroughly for the demonstration.

→ \_\_\_\_\_

15. It is about time the institution \_\_\_\_\_ (recognise) his exceptional contribution.

→ \_\_\_\_\_

Score : \_\_\_\_\_ / 15 points